GIAN BARBOZA

Senior Backend Engineer | Software Architect



Rionegro, Antioquia, Colombia · Full-time: remote, or on-site/hybrid in Medellín · Available on two weeks notice
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SUMMARY

Senior Backend Engineer and Software Architect with 10+ years of hands-on experience designing, building and evolving production systems — distributed architectures, multi-provider payment platforms, fraud detection, API integration and production infrastructure. Designed and led the migration of a single-server monolith to an 8-server distributed platform sustaining 99.9% uptime while processing $200K+ per month in transactions.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend Engineer — Hablax Inc.

Nov 2023 — Aug 2026 · Remote (100%)

- Took fraud response from weeks to hours with an extensible rule engine, and closed the account-fraud vector (multi-account abuse, account takeover) with a separate device-fingerprinting layer. Significantly cut manual review load, without adding friction for legitimate users.
- Unblocked modernization of a legacy stack that could not be upgraded in place, designing API gateways so new services integrated without a rewrite.
- Opened a new payment corridor with an end-to-end Shift4 integration: 3DS, tokenization, refunds and voids.
- Cut paid-advertising dependency with a programmatic SEO pipeline that scaled unattended with the catalog. Organic converted new clients better than the paid channel.
- Replaced ad-hoc customer messaging with a multi-channel notification orchestrator routing email and push by country, payment method and product.

Full Stack Developer → CTO — Hablax Inc.

Dec 2017 — Apr 2023 · Remote (100%)

- Ended recurring ~3-hour outages on the year's most lucrative dates (Mother's Day, New Year's Eve): designed and led the migration of a single-server monolith to an 8-server distributed architecture on DigitalOcean, executed manually over Linux due to legacy-stack constraints. 99.9% uptime since.
- Removed single-gateway risk from a global payments operation with a multi-provider architecture: configurable routing per product, automatic failover across PayPal, Payeezy and DLocal, and checkout widened with Apple Pay, Google Pay and in-house tokenization.
- Promoted from developer to CTO, leading 4 engineers through critical infrastructure migrations and feature delivery.
- Kept a multi-provider catalog accurate and swappable live: priority-based failover between suppliers plus automated daily async syncs, at zero downtime.
- Expanded revenue lines with travel booking (hotels, car rentals), money-transfer integration and a referral system.

Full Stack Engineer · Freelance — Independent Clients

Apr 2023 — Nov 2023 · Remote

- Took a digital-goods business from zero to selling end-to-end — storefront, checkout, automated delivery — on Next.js, TypeScript, Clean Architecture and Vitest.

- Made payments and fulfillment hands-off: full Stripe and PayPal integration (authorization, refunds) wired to automatic delivery of digital products.
- Gave the client operational autonomy with a custom admin for catalog, orders and fulfillment.

Java Software Developer — Fermat.org
Jan 2016 — Mar 2017 · Remote (100%)

- Removed intermediaries from consumer payments, building P2P Android apps on cryptocurrency infrastructure (ride-hailing, e-commerce) where funds settled wallet to wallet. First exposure to decentralized systems and fully remote work.

INDEPENDENT PROJECT

Rentoru — Independent Full Stack Developer
Venezuela long-term rentals · Public beta, still in development · Publicly available at https://rentoru.com · Corrections ahead of the marketing launch

- TypeScript/React/Next.js listings, drafts, filtered search, property management and CSV imports; domain/application/infrastructure layers, PostgreSQL/Drizzle/Neon.
- Auth.js Google OAuth/email via Resend; ownership authorization, rate-limited contacts; lifecycle emails, retries and scheduled cleanup.
- Signed, validated Cloudflare R2 uploads; Sharp WebP derivatives and perceptual deduplication.
- Vitest unit/integration and Playwright (including JS-disabled); GitHub Actions type/coverage/build/integration checks.

SELECTED ARCHITECTURE & SYSTEMS

- **Multi-Gateway Payment Architecture** — 5 providers (Stripe, PayPal, DLocal, Shift4, Payeezy) behind a single payment contract. Adapters normalize each API into shared request/response objects; Factory and Strategy decouple provider selection from behaviour; Builder assembles the complex requests, Repository isolates transaction persistence. Configurable routing and priority per product with automatic failover. 3DS, refunds, voids, Apple Pay, Google Pay, in-house tokenization.
- **Distributed Infrastructure Migration** — 8-server architecture on DigitalOcean separating web, database and dev tiers. HAProxy load balancing, MySQL master-slave replication, node-level failover, automated backups and recovery runbooks. 99.9% uptime sustained since 2019.
- **Extensible Fraud Detection Engine** — Rule architecture on Factory and Single Responsibility: rules self-register against a normalized context, so patterns plug in without touching the evaluator. Separate device-fingerprinting layer for access fraud. Also prototyped LLM-based contextual evaluation, imitating how a support agent decides. It stayed in beta and never reached production.
- **Programmatic SEO Pipeline** — 3-tier generation pipeline (country → service → product) on ChatGPT-4o, regenerating affected landings as the catalog grows. Replaced a significant portion of paid-ad spend with organic traffic.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Backend & Architecture** — Node.js (Express) · TypeScript · Next.js · PHP (Laravel, ~2 years; CodeIgniter) · Java · Redis (Caching) · REST APIs · API Architecture · Distributed Systems · Clean Architecture · Gateway Pattern · Design Patterns (Factory, Strategy, Adapter, Repository, Builder, SRP)
- **Infrastructure** — Linux · HAProxy · Nginx · MySQL Replication · PostgreSQL · DigitalOcean · Docker · GitHub Actions · Cronjobs
- **Payments & Risk** — Stripe · PayPal · DLocal · Shift4 · Payeezy · 3DS · Apple Pay · Google Pay · In-house Tokenization · Payment Routing · Fraud Rule Engines · Device Fingerprinting · PCI Compliance
- **Automation & AI** — LLM Integration · AI-assisted development (Claude Code, Codex) · AI-Assisted Fraud · Programmatic SEO · Content Automation · Web Scraping

LANGUAGES

- **Spanish** — Native
- **English** — C1 Advanced (EF SET Certificate) · ran supplier calls in English at Hablax

EDUCATION

Universidad Dr. Rafael Belloso Chacín (URBE) — Maracaibo, Venezuela · 2011 – 2015 *Ingeniero en Informática*